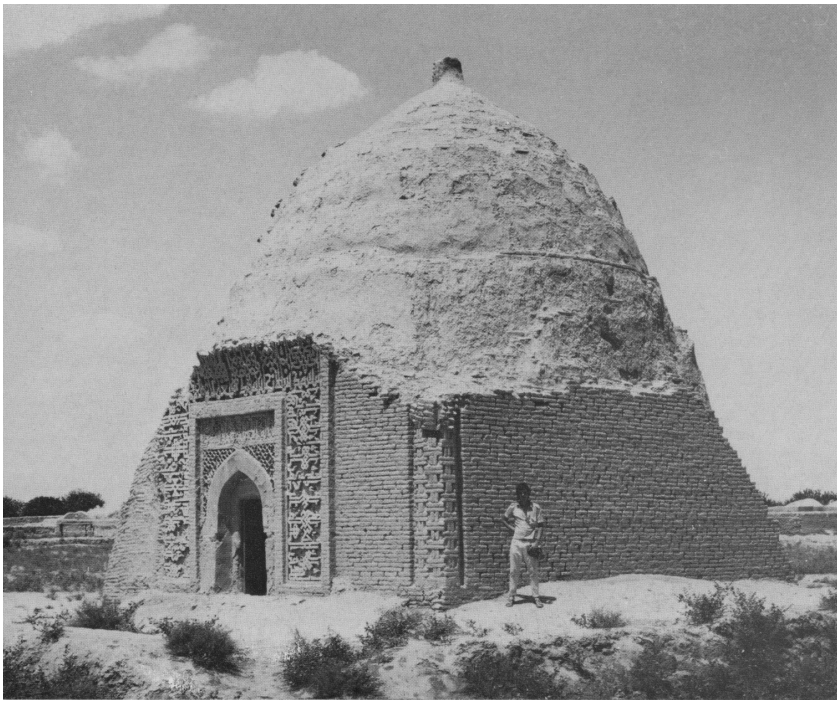


Figure I.16 *Tomb of Salar Khalil, a.k.a. ziyarat Baba Khatim (west of Balkh), Juzjan Province, Afghanistan. From Sourdel-Thomine 1971: fig. XI.*

a long-standing and ingrained building practice throughout Central Asia by the latter half of the twelfth century, utilized in both monumental commemorations of royalty and the nobility, and in smaller-scale structures, as is the case in these examples.[50] Salar Khalil's otherwise extensive epigraphic program recorded no date, while Shaikh Husain's exterior inscriptional frieze was too eroded to glean the content. Although the subject of some debate (cf. below), both tombs have been dated to the twelfth–thirteenth centuries.[51] These structures are amply useful for our purposes, as they illustrate the inclusive notion of an identifiable architectural culture and the variability within it, even at the non-royal ends of its expressive spectrum. They also demonstrate the heuristic value of identifying an architectural culture, which both shaped and *was* shaped by the patronage of elites and others alike.

While both tombs adhere to the overall format of a domed space, they diverge in their respective funerary chambers, one being quadrangular (Juzjan) and the other octagonal (Bust). Moreover, the Bust tomb was largely open to the elements, more akin to a pavilion sheltering a grave, while the Juzjan tomb was a closed "cube" with only the entrance aperture. The most noticeable difference between them, however, is the amount of decoration and the variation in the respective iconographies: the exteriors